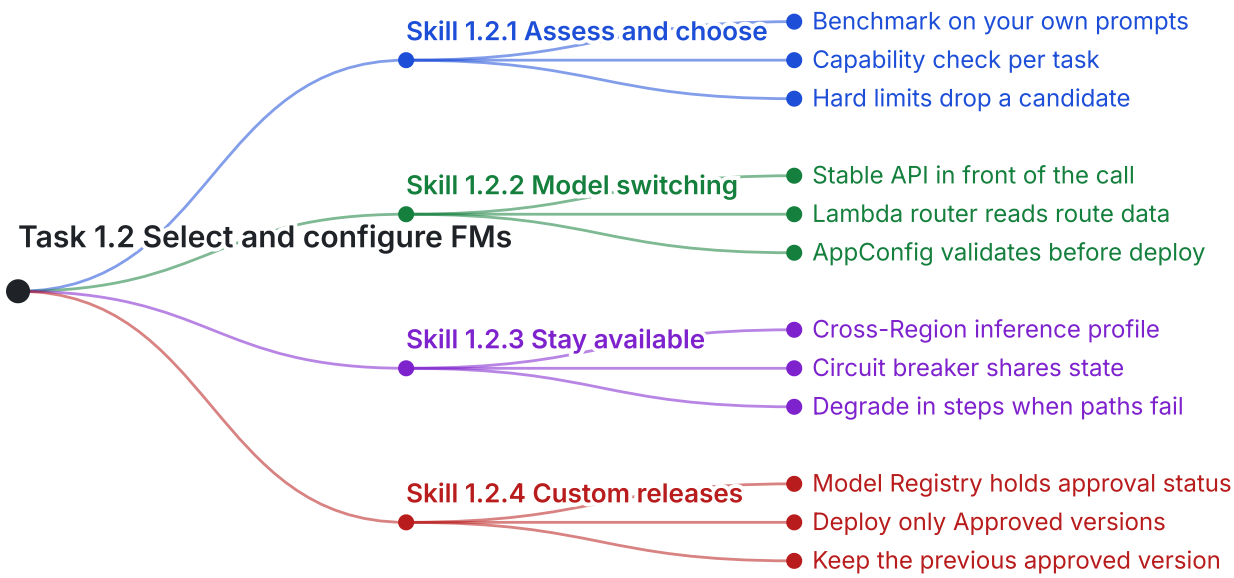
Memory sheet: Task 1.2 Select and configure FMs

Domain 1, weight 31 percent. Read this sheet, then answer the flash questions aloud.



Deciding rules

When the stem says	Think of	Not when
Two or more candidate models for one use case	One benchmark on the same prompts and limits	A public leaderboard already ranks one model first
Switch provider or tenant route without a code change	Route data in AppConfig with a Lambda router	One value changes and no validator or alarm rollback is needed
Residency rule names a geography	Geographic cross-Region inference profile	Only a cost goal is named, which points to a global profile
Outage or throttling, and the same model must stay	Cross-Region inference profile in modelId with bounded retries	Failures persist across many callers, which calls for a circuit breaker
Repeated calls keep failing against a dependency that is down	Circuit breaker with a shared status table	A short blip inside one call, which calls for retry with backoff
A reviewer must approve a version before it deploys	Model Registry approval status with a pipeline	Only S3 versioning is offered as the control
Many tuned variants of one base model	LoRA adapters registered over the shared base	The change needs a new model trained from scratch
Container or GPU control that Bedrock cannot give	SageMaker AI endpoint with a guarded rollout	Supported weights only need Bedrock calls, which points to Custom Model Import

Etch lines

1. Name the deciding constraint in three or four words before options.
2. Without a code change means the switch lives in configuration.
3. Plan bounded retries, since a profile cannot promise zero errors.
4. Inference profiles cannot use Provisioned Throughput.
5. Retire a version only after traffic has moved away from it.
6. An adapter file alone cannot run without its base model.

Flash questions

- Q: Where should a provider route live when the stem forbids a code change? A: In configuration, such as an AppConfig profile, outside the application code.
- Q: What evidence should decide between two candidate models? A: A performance benchmark run on the same prompts, Region, and response limit.
- Q: Which feature keeps one model answering during a Regional disruption? A: A cross-Region inference profile, passed in the model ID field.
- Q: When does a circuit breaker beat more retries? A: When a dependency stays down across many callers, since retries add load.
- Q: Does falling back to the same overloaded service degrade anything? A: No, the second call fails for the same reason as the first.
- Q: What must a version hold before a pipeline deploys it? A: An Approved status in Model Registry.
- Q: What stays ready when a live version is about to be replaced? A: The previous approved version, kept until the rollback window closes.
- Q: Why can an adapter-only release fail at deployment? A: The endpoint cannot load the adapter without the base model it was built on.

Source: Task 1.2 sections on the deciding constraint, Skill 1.2.1, Skill 1.2.2, Skill 1.2.3, Skill 1.2.4, Versus pairs, and Distractor patterns. AWS docs and the study guide sections above, no practice-test text.